

Standard Chartered

Strong income performance led by NII, Wealth and Banking, partly offset by Middle East provision overlays

StanChart 1Q results were strong with NII 3% ahead of company-consensus supported by +3% loan and deposit growth in the quarter, non-NII 8% ahead, and costs in line, driving pre-provision operating profits 13% ahead of expectations. Wealth (+32% y/y) had a strong quarter with \$18bn of net new money (c16% net flow rate), alongside Banking (+19% y/y) while Markets was flat y/y but with flow income +17% y/y. Balance sheet deployment and Market risk drove higher RWAs (+3% q/q), leading to CET1 40bps below expectations but within the target range. 2026 guidance remains unchanged with FY26E NII still expected to be broadly flat y/y although we see upside risk given the strong 1Q performance, and the Group will provide its medium-term financial framework in May. Impairments were 3% higher than expected at 32bps CoR, reflecting \$190m of post-model adjustments in relation to the Middle East and overlays for the petrochemical sector and potential sovereign downgrades. We welcome the detailed disclosures on the Middle East which outline c\$40bn of exposures (c6% of Group exposures), with >90% in the CIB weighted towards sovereign-linked counterparties, of which >75% is IG-rated with small sector exposures to CRE/hospitality. Overall, we expect low-single-digit% upgrades to consensus EPS 26-28E expectations driven by stronger revenues, particularly in Wealth. We remain OW, with the stock trading at 8.8x PE, 1.2x PTNAV for a ROTE of 14.5% 27E.

- **Noteworthy Areas:** 1) NII of \$2.87bn was 3% above cons and -3% q/q driven by lower rates partly offset by volume growth and mix benefit from client activity. AIEAs were +1% q/q with underlying loans +3.4% q/q driven by CIB loans +\$7.5bn q/q while WRB loans were +\$2.3bn q/q, and underlying deposits were +3.1% q/q driven by both CIB (+\$9.2bn) and WRB deposits (+\$6.9bn q/q), especially CASA deposits. 2) Other income of \$3.0bn was 8% above cons mainly driven strong growth in Wealth Solutions (+32% y/y) and Global Banking (+19% y/y). Total income was \$5.9bn and 6% above cons. 3) Costs of \$3.14bn were in line with cons, driving PPOP of \$2.8bn 13% above cons. 4) Credit impairments of \$296m (32bps loan loss rate) were 3% above cons and included \$190m of PMAs related to the Middle East conflict (for changing probability weights and a new Middle East downside scenario) and overlays for the petrochemical sector and potential sovereign downgrades, driving PBT of \$2.45bn 14% below cons. 5) CET1 of 13.4% was 40bps below cons with RWAs 2% above cons and +3% q/q driven by asset growth and market risk RWAs; 7) TNAV/sh was \$17.20 vs cons \$17.43.
- **Outlook & Guidance: 2026 Guidance unchanged:** 1) 2026 statutory RoTE guidance of >12% (cons 12.5%). 2) Reported income growth to be around the bottom end of 5-7% (const-fx base of c\$20.8bn, ex notables), implying 2026E revenues of \$21.8bn (vs cons \$21.95bn), with NII flat (cons in line). 3) Reported costs to be broadly flat y/y (const-fx base of c\$13.2bn, ex notables) with cons in line.
- **Performance by key product segments (const-FX):** 1Q: Global Markets flat

Overweight

STAN.L, STAN LN

Price (29 Apr 26): 1,790p

Price Target (Dec-27): 2200.0p

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y/y (1% below cons) with Flow income (+17% y/y) offset by episodic income (-31% y/y against a strong Q1'25). Global Banking +19% y/y (12% above cons) with Lending & Fin Solutions +14% y/y and Capital Markets & Advisory +58% y/y. Wealth +32% y/y (13% above cons) with \$18bn net new money or 16% of AUM annualized with \$12bn in Wealth (20% of Wealth AUM annualized).

- **Likely changes to consensus:** We expect low-single-digit% upgrades to consensus EPS 26-28E expectations driven by stronger revenues led by Wealth, with no change to absolute cost guidance for 2026E.
- **Peer read-across:** We see these results as a positive read-across for HSBC's Wealth revenues with StanChart Wealth income growth of +32% y/y in 1Q alongside net new money of \$18bn (inc. \$12bn in Wealth) at c16% inflow rate in 1Q.
- **Conference Call Details:** 08.00 UK [here](#)

Actual vs Expected:

Table 1: StanChart 1Q Group results

\$mn

	1Q25	4Q25	1Q26E	1Q26 Cons	1Q26A	A vs Cons.	A vs JPMe	Y/Y	Q/Q
NII	2,797	2,948	2,774	2,781	2,869	3%	3%	3%	-3%
Other Income	2,582	1,865	2,786	2,805	3,033	8%	9%	17%	63%
Revenue	5,379	4,813	5,560	5,586	5,902	6%	6%	10%	23%
o.w. Transaction Services	1,529	1,521	1,514	1,505	1,512	0%	0%	-1%	-1%
o.w. Global Banking	546	547	586	594	663	12%	13%	21%	21%
o.w. Global Markets	1,183	660	1,191	1,202	1,190	-1%	0%	1%	80%
o.w. Wealth Solutions	778	677	915	921	1,043	13%	14%	34%	54%
Operating expenses	-3,046	-3,754	-3,142	-3,142	-3,140	0%	0%	3%	-16%
Pre-provision operating profit	2,333	1,059	2,418	2,444	2,762	13%	14%	18%	161%
Loan impairments	-217	-148	-317	-287	-296	3%	-7%	36%	100%
Profits pre-Other impairments/Assocs	2,116	911	2,101	2,157	2,466	14%	17%	17%	171%
Other impairments	-15	-24	-7	-20	-2	-90%	-71%	-87%	-92%
Profit from associates	2	-27	1	7	-14	-300%	-1500%	-800%	-48%
Clean Pretax profits	2,103	860	2,095	2,144	2,450	14%	17%	17%	185%
Total one-offs	0	-46	0	0	0				
Pretax profits	2,103	814	2,095	2,144	2,450	14%	17%	17%	201%
RoTE	14.8%	4.8%	13.1%	8.5%	17.4%				
TNAV/s	\$15.62	\$17.30	\$17.29	\$17.43	\$17.20	-1%	-1%	10%	-1%
CET1 ratio	13.8%	14.1%	13.7%	13.8%	13.4%				
RWAs	254	258	260	262	266	2%	2%	5%	3%
Loans (ex FVTPL)	282	287	290	290	294	1%	1%	4%	2%
Customer deposits	491	530	540	539	542	1%	0%	10%	2%

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Company data.

Table 2: StanChart 1Q product revenues

\$mn

	1Q25	4Q25	1Q26E	1Q26 Cons	1Q26A	A vs Cons.	A vs JPMe	Y/Y	Q/Q
Transaction Services	1,529	1,521	1,514	1,505	1,512	0%	0%	-1%	-1%
Payments and Liquidity	1,063	1,064	1,032	1,033	1,037	0%	0%	-2%	-3%
Securities Services	151	173	157	163	177	9%	13%	17%	2%
Trade & Working Capital	315	284	324	309	298	-4%	-8%	-5%	5%
Banking	546	547	586	594	663	12%	13%	21%	21%
Lending & Financial Solutions	450	483	482	493	511	4%	6%	14%	6%
Capital Market & Advisory	96	64	105	101	152	50%	45%	58%	138%
Markets	1,183	660	1,191	1,202	1,190	-1%	0%	1%	80%
Wealth Solutions	778	677	915	921	1,043	13%	14%	34%	54%
Investment Products	560	553	675	677	778	15%	15%	39%	41%
Bancassurance	218	124	240	239	265	11%	11%	22%	114%
CCPL & Other Unsecured Lending	269	320	241	286	296	3%	23%	10%	-8%
Deposits & Mortgages	1,022	1,065	1,054	1,034	1,017	-2%	-4%	0%	-5%
Treasury & Other	53	23	60	55	181	229%	204%	242%	687%

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Company data.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Standard Chartered (*Overweight; Price Target: 2200.0p*)

Investment Thesis

We view StanChart as undervalued relative to the sector/EM peers at 1.2x PTNAV 27E with significant earnings growth potential supported by structural growth drivers and relatively high capital return. With the Group's 24-26E targets already achieved by FY25 across revenues and distributions, we now forecast c5% revenue growth CAGR across '25-28E driven by non-NII in 26E, and broadening out to both NII/non-NII in outer years. We see this led by Wealth (driven by Affluent segment opportunities), Financial Markets (alongside cross-border income) and Banking. We expect NII +1% y/y due to lower rates and pass throughs offset by volume growth. We expect cost growth at a c3.5% CAGR 25-28E as we expect growing investments in the future to capitalise on productivity and revenue opportunities, with positive operating leverage expected annually and the CIR to decline towards mid-50s. Overall, we expect stated ROTE to grow to c15%, alongside a 35% dividend payout ratio and \$2bn/y buybacks, offering a total yield of 7-8%/y.

Valuation

We value StanChart using a SOTP methodology with divisional multiples differentiated by type of business. We value Corporate, Commercial and Institutional Banking at 8.5x P/E, and Consumer, Private & Business Banking Commercial at 10.0x P/E. We value excess capital above 13.0% at 1x. Our Dec-27 PT is 2,200p.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

- **Macroeconomic risks:** Being an EM-focused bank, StanChart is exposed to general macroeconomic risk in EM such as slowdowns, inflationary pressures, depreciation of EM currencies and cross border and political risks. COVID-19 continues to be a risk towards revenues and impairments in the near term, particularly in Asian economies, as well as geopolitical tensions creating a potential headwind.
- **Provisioning outlook:** We expect provisions at normalised levels across the medium term given growing pressures in the economic environment. An increase or decrease in provisions as a result of the economic outlook or with regards to specific cases poses a risk to our forecasts.
- **Regulatory uncertainty:** Standard Chartered remains exposed to changes in the regulatory environment in the UK, with capital requirements being set by the PRA in the UK. While StanChart has limited UK exposure, the Group is still subject to regulatory changes such as Basel 4 and BoE stress tests.

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HSBC Holdings plc(HSBA.L/1,331p/N)

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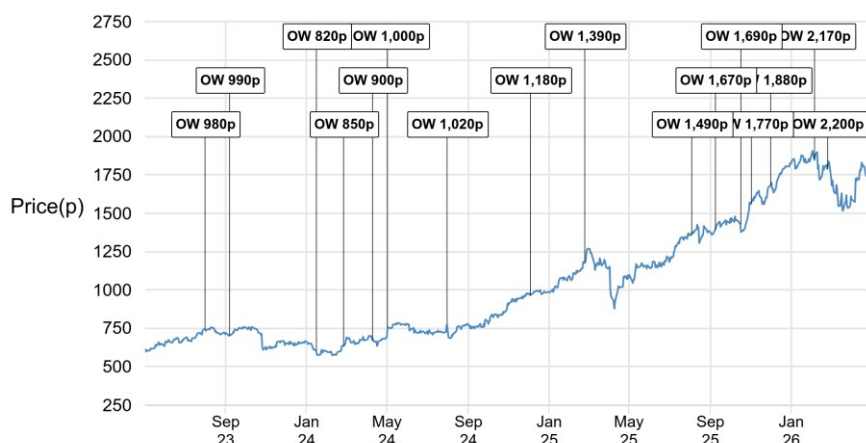
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Standard Chartered (STAN.L, STAN LN) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends. Initiated coverage Jun 27, 2001. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

HSBC Holdings plc (HSBA.L, HSBA LN) Price Chart



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Date	Rating	Price (p)	Price Target (p)
01-Aug-23	OW	747	980
07-Sep-23	OW	702	990
16-Jan-24	OW	605	820
26-Feb-24	OW	635	850
10-Apr-24	OW	673	900
03-May-24	OW	756	1,000
31-Jul-24	OW	770	1,020
04-Dec-24	OW	966	1,180
24-Feb-25	OW	1183	1,390
04-Aug-25	OW	1355	1,490
09-Sep-25	OW	1391	1,670
17-Oct-25	OW	1428	1,690
03-Nov-25	OW	1560	1,770
02-Dec-25	OW	1681	1,880
05-Feb-26	OW	1857	2,170
25-Feb-26	OW	1789	2,200

Date	Rating	Price (p)	Price Target (p)
07-Jul-23	N	610	680
16-Oct-23	N	653	690
16-Jan-24	N	596	660
22-Feb-24	N	590	600
10-Apr-24	N	645	660
01-May-24	N	696	700
15-Nov-24	N	706	730
06-Dec-24	N	751	780
20-Feb-25	N	895	900
20-Mar-25	N	896	920
01-May-25	N	832	830
01-Aug-25	N	923	870
09-Sep-25	N	970	940
17-Oct-25	N	989	950
29-Oct-25	N	1050	1,010
02-Dec-25	N	1080	1,060
05-Feb-26	N	1308	1,190
17-Mar-26	N	1196	1,360

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